

Novapulse - Gap Analysis Document

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Field	Detail
Document Title	NovaPulse-BA — Gap Analysis v1.0
Version	1.0
Status	Final
Author	Abinеш - Senior Business Analyst
Date	21/05/2026
Related Artefacts	Project Charter v1.0, Business Context v1.0, Analysis Findings v1.0

1. Purpose and Scope :

This Gap Analysis documents the current state (As-Is) of NovaPulse's product, pricing, support, and analytics capabilities against the desired future state (To-Be) required to achieve the monetisation and retention objectives identified in the NovaPulse-BA engagement. Each gap is prioritised, assigned an impact rating, and linked to a responsible owner.

Analytical Foundation : All As-Is assessments are derived from analysis of 5,000 subscription records, 25,000 feature usage events, 2,000 support tickets, and 600 churn events. To-Be states are informed by industry benchmarks and the monetisation strategy recommendations in NovaPulse-BA_MonetisationStrategy_v1.0. (before doc)

2. Gap Summary

Priority	Count	Gap Areas	Target Quarter
Critical	2	Pricing Architecture, Feature Gating	Immediate Q1 2025

High	6	Support SLA, Onboarding, AI Positioning, Churn Analytics, Satisfaction, Annual Billing	Q1-Q2 2025
Medium	5	Reporting, Upsell Triggers, Cohort Monitoring, Self-Service, Billing Incentive	Q2-Q3 2025
Low	2	Beta Feature Graduation, Documentation	Q3-Q4 2025

Total Gaps Identified: 15

3. Gap Analysis

3.1 Pricing and Revenue Architecture

GAP G01 — Pricing Architecture

Priority : Critical

Owner: CRO

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Three flat-rate tiers with no intermediate options. Starter at \$29 is uncompetitive for solo users versus per-seat competitors charging \$7-\$11 per user per month. Pricing sensitivity analysis shows budget is the third largest churn driver at 17.3% of all 600 churn events. No pricing scenario modelling has been performed before this engagement.	Growth tier repriced at \$99 per month for all new subscriptions with 60-day grace period for existing customers. Annual billing discount of 20% formally marketed. Scenario 3 full tier restructure (Starter \$19, Growth \$89, Enterprise \$229) targeted for Q4 2025 after upsell conversion improves.

Business Impact:

Scenario 2 pricing change generates +\$56,673 ARR — a 10.6% revenue uplift based on financial modelling in NovaPulse-BA_PricingModel_v1.0.

Gap Actions Required:

- Update billing system to support \$99 Growth tier pricing

- Build 60-day customer communication flow
 - Create annual billing incentive at checkout
 - Model pricing change impact monthly for 6 months post-launch
-

GAP G02 — Feature Gating

Priority : Critical

Owner: CPO + Engineering

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
No feature gating between Starter and Growth tiers. All users access similar feature sets regardless of tier. The gap score analysis of 25,000 feature usage events identified that Growth and Enterprise users engage with In-App Comments, Real-Time Notifications, Gantt Chart, Workflow Automation, and Custom Dashboards at significantly higher rates than Starter users. Without gating, Starter users have no compelling reason to upgrade.	Top 5 upsell trigger features gated behind Growth tier with soft usage limits visible to Starter users. Starter users see the feature exists, hit a usage limit, and receive an upgrade prompt with one-click upgrade path. Feature gating is implemented without removing any currently available Starter functionality to avoid triggering a mass churn response.

Business Impact:

Feature gating is the primary mechanism driving the 15% upsell conversion rate assumption in Scenario 2. Estimated additional ARR from upsell: \$29,700 within 6 months.

Gap Actions Required:

- Implement access controls for 5 designated features
 - Build upgrade prompt UI component
 - Build soft usage limit notification system
 - Instrument upgrade prompt impressions and conversions
-

GAP G03 — Annual Billing Incentive

Priority: High

Owner: CRO + Finance

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Monthly and annual billing options exist but no structured incentive drives annual adoption. Annual billing customers have lower churn exposure because they commit for 12 months rather than renewing monthly. The cohort analysis shows that accounts surviving M6 have dramatically lower churn — annual billing locks customers into this high-retention zone from day one.	20% annual billing discount formally marketed at subscription signup and at monthly renewal reminder. Annual billing adoption target of 40% within 12 months. Annual subscribers offered price lock guarantee - protects against price increases for the committed term.

Business Impact:

Shifting 40% of subscriptions to annual billing reduces monthly churn exposure by approximately 40% for those accounts. Indirect ARR protection estimated at \$5,000-\$8,000 annually based on current churn rates.

Gap Actions Required:

- Update pricing page to prominently display annual option
 - Build renewal reminder email with annual upgrade CTA
 - Add annual billing discount logic to billing system
 - Track annual vs monthly adoption rate monthly
-

GAP G04 - Upsell Conversion Flow

Priority: High

Owner: CPO + Marketing

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Starter to Growth upsell conversion is estimated at 8%. No in-product upgrade prompts exist. No contextual triggers fire at feature usage limits. The upgrade path requires a customer to proactively navigate to the pricing page and make a purchase decision without any in-product nudge.	Contextual upgrade prompts trigger at feature limit touchpoints. Weekly product digest sent to all Starter accounts highlighting Growth features with personalised usage comparisons. Target: 12% Starter to Growth conversion within 6 months. 15% within 12 months.

Business Impact:

Increasing conversion from 8% to 12% generates approximately 7 additional Growth accounts per month at \$99 each — \$8,316 additional monthly MRR or \$99,792 ARR uplift at steady state.

Gap Actions Required:

- Build weekly digest email and in-app notification system
 - Instrument all upgrade CTA clicks and conversion events
 - A/B test upgrade prompt copy for optimisation
 - Report conversion funnel weekly to CPO and CRO
-

3.2 Product and Feature Capabilities

GAP G05 — AI Feature Positioning

Priority: High

Owner: CPO

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
AI Task Suggestions, Smart Deadline Predictor, and AI Meeting Notes Sync exist as beta features with no formal tier positioning, no marketing, and no pricing association. Despite this, AI Task Suggestions ranks 12th of 40 features by usage volume — top 30% adoption without any promotion. Enterprise and Growth tier adoption is higher than Starter, confirming natural premium tier alignment.	AI features formally graduated from beta to GA status. Positioned as Enterprise-exclusive differentiators in all marketing materials, pricing pages, and product communications. Enterprise pricing of \$229 in Scenario 3 is partially justified by AI capability exclusivity.

Business Impact:

AI feature exclusivity strengthens the Enterprise value proposition and supports the \$229 Enterprise price point in the full restructure scenario. Estimated contribution to Scenario 3 ARR uplift.

Gap Actions Required:

- Remove beta labels from all three AI features in UI
 - Update Enterprise pricing page and marketing materials
 - Publish help centre documentation for all three features
 - Track AI feature adoption in Enterprise tier post-launch
-

GAP G06 — Onboarding Experience

Priority: High

Owner: CPO + CS

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
No structured onboarding flow exists. Cohort retention data shows the steepest retention decay occurs between M1 and M6 — indicating users are not reaching product value fast enough in the critical early months. The loyalty threshold identified at M6 means customers who survive 6 months tend to stay long-term. The current lack of onboarding leaves retention in the first 6 months to chance.	Structured 30-day onboarding programme for all new accounts including in-app feature guides for the top 5 core features. Customer success touchpoint at Day 14 for all accounts not completing the Day 7 onboarding step. Onboarding completion rate tracked as a leading retention indicator.

Business Impact:

Improving M1 retention by 2 percentage points across all cohorts would protect approximately \$890 in monthly MRR based on current churn rates. Annualised: \$10,680.

Gap Actions Required:

- Design 30-day onboarding sequence content
 - Build in-app guided tour for top 5 core features
 - Implement Day 14 CS flag for incomplete onboarding
 - Track onboarding completion rate by cohort
-

GAP G07 — Collaboration Feature Depth

Priority: Medium

Owner: CPO

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
In-App Comments and Real-Time Notifications show the highest gap scores between Starter and Growth tiers. Growth users engage with collaboration features 35%+ more than Starter users. This usage gap is the primary commercial signal for feature gating but also indicates the underlying collaboration feature set may not be deep enough to fully satisfy Growth tier needs.	Collaboration features enhanced with additional capability in the Growth tier. Threading in comments, @mention notifications, and team activity feeds added as Growth-exclusive enhancements. These additions increase the perceived gap between Starter and Growth — strengthening upgrade intent.

Business Impact

Deeper collaboration features reduce competitor-driven churn (currently 15.3% of all churns, highest in Growth tier) by improving product stickiness.

Gap Actions Required:

- Conduct Growth tier user research on collaboration pain points
 - Prioritise collaboration feature enhancements in Q3 roadmap
 - Measure Growth tier satisfaction score before and after release
-

GAP G08 — Beta Feature Graduation

Priority: Low

Owner: CPO + Engineering

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Three beta features have no defined graduation path to GA. AI Task Suggestions shows strong organic adoption — ranked 12th of 40 features by total usage despite zero marketing. No release criteria exist for beta feature graduation.	Beta feature graduation framework established with clear release criteria — adoption threshold, error rate threshold, documentation requirement. All three AI features graduated to GA within Q3 2025 timeline.

Business Impact:

Indirect — supports Enterprise pricing story and reduces customer confusion about product maturity.

Gap Actions Required:

- Define beta graduation release criteria
 - Schedule GA release dates for all three AI features
 - Update product documentation and in-app labels
-

3.3 Customer Support and Success

GAP G09 — Support SLA Model

Priority: Critical

Owner: VP CS

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
No tiered SLA model exists. All tiers receive the same priority in the support queue. Enterprise customers wait 89.1 minutes for a first response — the same as Starter customers paying \$29 per month. Average resolution time for Enterprise is 36.9 hours. Support is the top Starter churn reason and the second largest Growth churn reason. This is the most operationally correctable churn driver in the entire dataset.	Tiered SLA model implemented via priority queuing. Enterprise : • 30-minute first response, 24-hour resolution. Growth • 60-minute first response, 48-hour resolution. Starter: • 120-minute first response, 72-hour resolution. Implementation requires only queue configuration changes, no additional headcount needed.

Business Impact:

Support-driven churn represents 104 events — 17.3% of all 600 churns. Reducing support churn by 30% through SLA improvement would prevent approximately 31 churns. At average revenue per churn event of \$103, that is \$3,193 monthly MRR protected — \$38,316 ARR.

Gap Actions Required:

- Configure priority queuing by account tier in support system
 - Set SLA timers for all three tiers
 - Build manager alert system for approaching SLA breaches
 - Report SLA compliance weekly — target 90% within 60 days
-

GAP G10 — Satisfaction Score Improvement

Priority: High

Owner: VP CS

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Average satisfaction scores are Starter 4.0, Growth 3.9, Enterprise 4.0 out of 5. Growth tier scoring lowest at 3.9 correlates directly with support being its second largest churn driver. World-class SaaS support typically achieves 4.5 and above. Even the 0.1 point difference between Growth and other tiers is commercially significant given Growth generates 731 tickets — the highest volume of any tier.	Growth satisfaction target 4.2 within 90 days. Enterprise satisfaction target 4.4 within 6 months. Dedicated Growth CS representative assigned. Monthly satisfaction review cadence established with VP CS and CPO.

Business Impact:

Improving Growth satisfaction from 3.9 to 4.2 directly reduces support-driven Growth churn, which represents 43 of the 104 total support churn events — the highest tier count for any churn reason.

Gap Actions Required:

- Assign dedicated CS rep to Growth tier accounts
 - Implement post-ticket CSAT survey for all ticket closures
 - Monthly satisfaction score review with VP CS
 - Publish CSAT improvement target as CS team OKR
-

GAP G11 — Self-Service Support

Priority: Medium

Owner: VP CS + Engineering

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
No knowledge base or self-service support capability exists. High ticket volume of 2,000 tickets across 500 accounts — average 4 tickets per account — suggests users cannot self-resolve common issues. Every ticket represents CS cost and a customer satisfaction risk.	Searchable in-app knowledge base with minimum 50 articles covering the top 20 most-ticketed feature areas. Accessible from in-app help button and support portal. Ticket deflection rate tracked weekly with target of 20% reduction in ticket volume within 6 months.

Business Impact:

20% ticket deflection reduces CS workload by approximately 400 tickets — freeing CS resource for high-value proactive outreach. Indirect churn reduction estimated at 5-8% of support-driven churns.

Gap Actions Required:

- Identify top 20 most-ticketed features from support data
 - Write 50 knowledge base articles — prioritise top features
 - Build in-app help button with search functionality
 - Track deflection rate monthly
-

3.4 Analytics and Business Intelligence

GAP G12 — Cohort Monitoring

Priority: High

Owner: Data + CS

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
No cohort early warning system exists. The anomalous 2024-05 cohort (58.0% M18 retention) and 2024-11 cohort (55.7% M15 retention) were identified only through retrospective analysis in this engagement. H2 2024 cohorts contain 953 subscriptions in December alone — their M12 retention is completely unknown and represents the largest single revenue uncertainty in the business.	Real-time cohort dashboard monitoring M3 and M6 retention by cohort. Automated alert when any cohort retention drops 5% below the rolling average. CS outreach triggered for at-risk accounts in months 4 and 5 — the highest-impact intervention window identified in the retention analysis.

Business Impact:

Early intervention on at-risk cohorts targets the 6-month loyalty threshold. Protecting even 5% of at-risk accounts from the December 2024 cohort of 953 subscriptions — approximately 48 accounts — at average revenue of \$89 per account represents \$4,272 monthly MRR or \$51,264 ARR protected.

Gap Actions Required:

- Build cohort retention dashboard with monthly refresh
 - Implement automated at-risk cohort alert
 - Define CS outreach playbook for at-risk accounts
 - Review cohort performance in monthly business review
-

GAP G13 — Churn Prediction

Priority: Medium

Owner: Data + Engineering

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Churn is identified only after the event occurs. No predictive model uses leading indicators such as feature usage decline, support ticket volume increase, or satisfaction score deterioration to identify at-risk accounts before they cancel.	Churn risk scoring model built using feature usage frequency, support ticket volume, satisfaction score, and months_active as weighted inputs. Weekly at-risk account report delivered to CS team every Monday. CS outreach logged and tracked against churn outcomes.

Business Impact:

Predictive churn intervention is estimated to reduce churn events by 10-15% based on industry benchmarks for proactive CS engagement programmes.

Gap Actions Required:

- Define churn risk scoring methodology and weightings
 - Build risk score calculation on weekly data refresh
 - Create at-risk account report for CS team
 - Track intervention success rate quarterly
-

GAP G14 — Revenue Analytics

Priority: Medium

Owner: Data + Finance

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
MRR and ARR are tracked at account level but no real-time tier-level revenue dashboard exists. No LTV to CAC tracking is in place. No upgrade funnel visibility exists. Revenue decisions in this engagement required manual data extraction and modelling — not a sustainable operating model.	Power BI dashboard with real-time MRR by tier, ARR trajectory, LTV to CAC ratio by tier, and upgrade funnel conversion rates. Weekly automated revenue report to CRO. Dashboard accessible to Finance Director for business case validation.

Business Impact:

Real-time revenue visibility enables faster commercial decision-making. Tier-level MRR tracking immediately shows the impact of pricing changes, allowing rapid response if Growth churn exceeds assumptions.

Gap Actions Required:

- Build Power BI revenue dashboard with DAX measures
 - Connect to billing system data source
 - Implement LTV to CAC calculation by tier
 - Schedule weekly automated report to CRO and CFO
-

GAP G15 — Feature Adoption Tracking

Priority: Medium

Owner: CPO + Data

As - Is (Current State)	To - Be (Future State)
Feature usage data exists in the database but no operational dashboard surfaces adoption rates to the product team in real time. Feature decisions are made without adoption evidence. The feature adoption analysis in this engagement required manual pivot table construction across 25,000 rows — not repeatable at scale.	Feature adoption dashboard showing weekly active usage by feature and tier. Adoption rate alerts when any feature drops below a defined threshold. Dashboard feeds directly into sprint planning so product decisions are evidence-based.

Business Impact:

Evidence-based feature prioritisation reduces wasted development investment. Features with declining adoption are candidates for deprecation or improvement — freeing engineering resource for higher-value work.

Gap Actions Required:

- Build feature adoption dashboard in Power BI
 - Define adoption rate alert thresholds by feature category
 - Present adoption data in monthly product review
 - Link adoption dashboard to sprint planning process
-

4. PRIORITY AND EFFORT MATRIX

Gap ID	Gap Area	Impact	Effort	Quadrant	Action
G09	Tiered Support SLA	High	Low	Quick Win	Implement immediately
G02	Feature Gating	High	Low	Quick Win	Implement Q1 2025
G04	Upsell Conversion Flow	High	Low	Quick Win	Implement Q1 2025
G01	Pricing Architecture	High	Medium	Strategic	Implement Q1 2025
G06	Onboarding Experience	High	Medium	Strategic	Design Q1, Build Q2
G12	Cohort Monitoring	High	Medium	Strategic	Build Q2 2025
G10	Satisfaction Improvement	High	Low	Quick Win	Process change Q1
G03	Annual Billing Incentive	High	Low	Quick Win	Marketing change Q1
G05	AI Feature Positioning	Medium	Low	Quick Win	Marketing change Q2
G11	Self-Service Support	Medium	Medium	Strategic	Build Q2-Q3 2025
G13	Churn Prediction	Medium	High	Major Project	Q3 2025

G14	Revenue Analytics	Medium	Medium	Strategic	Build Q2 2025
G15	Feature Adoption Tracking	Medium	Medium	Strategic	Build Q2 2025
G07	Collaboration Depth	Medium	High	Major Project	Q3 2025
G08	Beta Feature Graduation	Low	Medium	Tactical	Q3 2025

5. GAP TO ARTEFACT TRACEABILITY

Gap ID	Gap Area	BRD Section	User Stories	Roadmap Quarter
G01	Pricing Architecture	BR-PR-01	US-01, US-02, US-03	Q1 2025
G02	Feature Gating	BR-PR-03	US-12, US-13, US-14	Q1 2025
G03	Annual Billing Incentive	BR-PR-04	US-03	Q1 2025
G04	Upsell Conversion Flow	BR-PR-05	US-04, US-10	Q1 2025
G05	AI Feature Positioning	BR-PD-03	US-06, US-08	Q2 2025

G06	Onboarding Experience	BR-PD-01	US-07, US-11	Q1-Q2 2025
G07	Collaboration Feature Depth	BR-PD-06	US-16	Q3 2025
G08	Beta Feature Graduation	BR-PD-03	US-08	Q3 2025
G09	Support SLA Model	BR-SP-01, BR-SP-02	US-17, US-18	Q1 2025
G10	Satisfaction Improvement	BR-SP-04	US-19, US-20	Q1 2025
G11	Self-Service Support	BR-SP-05	US-21	Q2-Q3 2025
G12	Cohort Monitoring	BR-AN-02	US-23, US-24	Q2 2025
G13	Churn Prediction	BR-AN-04	US-24	Q3 2025
G14	Revenue Analytics	BR-AN-01	US-22, US-25	Q2 2025
G15	Feature Adoption Tracking	BR-AN-05	US-09	Q2 2025
